The method `redefine_method` prevents such a potential warning, removing the existing method before if needed.
Defined in `active_support/core_ext/module/remove_method.rb`

4 Extensions to `Class`

4.1 Class Attributes

4.1.1 `class_attribute`

The method `class_attribute` declares one or more inheritable class attributes that can be overridden at any level down the hierarchy.

```
class A
  class_attribute :x
end

class B < A; end

class C < B; end

A.x = :a
B.x # => :a
C.x # => :a

B.x = :b
A.x # => :a
C.x # => :b

C.x = :c
A.x # => :a
B.x # => :b
```

For example `ActionMailer::Base` defines:

```
class_attribute :default_params
self.default_params = {
  mime_version: "1.0",
  charset: "UTF-8",
  content_type: "text/plain",
  parts_order: [ "text/plain", "text/enriched", "text/html" ]
}.freeze
```

They can also be accessed and overridden at the instance level.

```
A.x = 1

a1 = A.new
a2 = A.new
a2.x = 2

a1.x # => 1, comes from A
a2.x # => 2, overridden in a2
```

The generation of the writer instance method can be prevented by setting the option `:instance_writer` to `false`.

```
module ActiveRecord
  class Base
    class_attribute :table_name_prefix, instance_writer: false
    self.table_name_prefix = ""
  end
end
```

A model may find that option useful as a way to prevent mass-assignment from setting the attribute.